

CMP6200/DIG6200

Individual Undergraduate

Project (FYP) Handbook 2026–2027

This handbook is intended to be used towards the completion of the 40 credits individual undergraduate project CMP6200/DIG6200 within the following courses:

- BSc Business Information Technology
 - BSc Computer and Artificial Intelligence
 - BSc Computer and Data Science
 - BSc Computing and Information Technology
 - BSc Computer Science
 - BSc Computer Forensics
 - BSc Computer Games Technology
 - BSc Computer Networks and Security
 - BSc Computing Top-up
 - BSc Digital Media Computing
 - BSc Digital Media Technology
 - BSc Music Technology
 - BSc Sound Engineering and Production
 - BSc Film Production Technology
 - BSc Film Technology and Visual Effects
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Table of Contents

1. Introduction.....	1
1.1. Project Support	2
1.2. Supervisors	2
1.3. The Project Module	2
2. Aims and Objectives	2
2.1. Learning Outcomes.....	3
2.2. Transferable Skills.....	3
3. Project Management	3
3.1. Project Logbook	2
3.2. Project Timeline	3
4. Assessment Overview and Criteria	4
4.1. Assessment Templates.....	4
4.2. Style and Conventions	5
4.3. Ethics Review	6
4.4. References, Bibliography, and Appendices.....	7
4.5. Submission of work	7
4.6. Assessment Marking.....	8
5. Innovation Fest Awards and Henderson Innovation Seed Fund.....	8

1. Introduction

This project is a distinctive module that gives you the chance to explore an area of personal interest that excites you. It spans an entire year and includes several staged assessments designed to help you develop your initial idea into a final project report.

The module aims to enable you to undertake a sustained project exploring a suitable and relevant area aligned with your study programme, emphasising why this problem is essential, appropriate, and feasible. At this level, you will be expected to work independently but receive additional one-to-one support from your supervisor, who will be familiar with your chosen topic area.

Take the time to read this document thoroughly. It outlines the project process and covers key details. However, do not rely solely on this document; meet regularly with your supervisor. Although projects are unique in nature, the stages you will go through can be broadly summarised as:

Idea: In consultation with your supervisor, you will select your topic, resulting in an artefact accompanied by contextual material. Consider how this topic relates to your future academic or professional development.

Note:

In the context of your project, an artefact is the primary output or result that fulfils a defined purpose and addresses the specific problem identified at the start of the project. Therefore, an artefact should:

- Address a clearly defined problem and be systematically designed to achieve its intended purpose effectively.
- Employ appropriate knowledge, principles, professional standards, best practices, tools, and methods to test, evaluate, validate, or justify the artefact.
- Be either tangible, such as software code, hardware, or a network setup, or conceptual/documented, as exemplified by a detailed theoretical framework, a complex model, or a comprehensive design specification intended for future construction.
- Below are examples of artefacts, but this list is not exhaustive:
 - Frameworks / Models such as Cloud adoption framework, Data governance model, Business intelligence dashboard.
 - Software design, System Architecture, Algorithms, Machine learning/AI models, Recommendation engine, Procedural level-generation algorithm.
 - Network tools and frameworks, penetration testing framework, Network traffic anomaly detection system, and Zero-Trust security model.
 - Prototypes, UX/UI design, 3D-rendered virtual environment, game engine, Multiplayer networking system, Motion sensing using Arduino/Raspberry Pi, Haptic feedback devices.
 - Real-time music synthesis engine, Motion graphics piece, Deep-learning-based music composition assistant, Digital effects processing plugin, custom-built synthesisers, MIDI controllers, Real-time audio effect processors, and Spatial audio systems for VR/AR, Digital or analogue hardware, Digital Films and so on.

1.1. Project Support

Regular tutorials are held in the first six weeks of semester one and the last six weeks of semester 2. These tutorials will take the form of workshops, where you can ask any project-related questions. All supporting documentation for the module is available on Moodle, where you will find up-to-date assessment details, submission points and tutorial information, including:

- Current version of this handbook
- Assessment Briefs
- Module specification
- Project Templates
- Ethical Forms
- Tutorial presentations
- Supporting resources

Read assessment briefs on Moodle, and access the module page regularly, as all communication will be through Moodle. The project team will support students during weekly sessions and collaborate with the module leader to address any issues with marks or supervision. Please refer to Moodle to see the complete list of the project team and their contact details.

1.2. Supervisors

As final-year BSc students, you are expected to work independently on your projects; however, you will be assigned a supervisor familiar with your chosen topic area. These meetings can be one-to-one or in groups. The sessions may be face-to-face or online; your supervisor will communicate the format and arrangements.

Note:

- It is your responsibility to ensure that your supervisor is kept up to date with your progress.
- If you encounter any problems, contact your supervisor or course leader immediately.

1.3. The Project Module

This is a 40-credit module, running across two semesters. As a double module, the project mark will have a substantial impact on your degree classification.

Often, the project will relate directly to your career and provide a vehicle for enhancing your professional skills and understanding of the broader issues facing practitioners in your field.

This module offers you an opportunity to develop not only academically but also to acquire lifelong skills and attributes that identify you as a graduate. These include being a creative problem solver, entrepreneurial, professional, and work-ready, and having a global outlook. The project supports many of the programme's aims by providing the skills needed to develop innovative solutions, strategies, and ideas now and in the future.

2. Aims and Objectives

The Individual Honours Project aims to give you an opportunity to:

- Develop solutions that demonstrate an awareness of professional standards relevant to your discipline.

- Gain an understanding of successful project planning, which may include budget, time management and other relevant constraints.
- Be innovative, experimental, self-evaluate and reflect critically on your work, placing it within the context of relevant debates within your chosen topic.
- Discuss the exact nature of the artefact you create to ensure its relevance to your subject discipline.
- Independent investigation, allowing you to demonstrate initiative and make use of skills and knowledge acquired from the whole course.

2.1. Learning Outcomes

On successful completion of the module, students will be able to:

- Review the existing academic or professional knowledge base to scope and substantiate a discipline-relevant problem.
- Formulate and manage an iterative project plan to address the identified problem, considering feasibility, risks, and ethical aspects.
- Apply discipline-specific methodologies and techniques to design the artefact that addresses the identified problem.
- Implement the designed artefact to address the intended purpose.
- Critically evaluate the artefact's relevance and impact within a suitable societal, industry or scholarly context.
- Effectively communicate the project outcomes to diverse audiences.

2.2. Transferable Skills

The transferable skills that may be developed are:

Critical Thinking, Critical Analysis, Reflection, Problem Identification and Solving, Application of Technical Knowledge

- | | |
|------------------------------------|--|
| • Managing your learning | • Resilience |
| • Adherence to Technical Standards | • Planning and Management |
| • Information Synthesis | • Reception and Responsiveness to Feedback |
| • Decision-making | • IT skills |
| • Academic writing | • Communication |
| • Adaptability | • Organisation and Time Management |
| • Problem Analysis | • Presentation Skills. |
| • Initiative | |
| • Technical Design | |

3. Project Management

Projects involve multiple components and requirements that meet the delivery of the project-specific outputs and outcomes. Therefore, focus on the agreed-upon deliverables, which you discussed with your supervisors well in advance. If you feel like you're falling behind on your timelines, seek guidance and support from your supervisor to stay on track and overcome obstacles.

Some tips to plan and manage your project:

- You need to plan how you will undertake the project strategically.
- You need to effectively identify the different methods you could apply throughout the entirety of the project.
- Select, with justification, which methods you plan to use, and produce a timeline that indicates when activities will take place.
- It is essential that you regularly review your idea, discuss it with your supervisor and produce a detailed set of requirements and specifications.
- Ensure you give sufficient time and thought to the artefact design and/or implementation, allowing time for testing and/or evaluation so that you can explain and justify the project outcomes critically.
- It is helpful to summarise key research information from multiple sources using tables, diagrams, and charts; however, do not simply place a summary of each source in a table. Instead, critically analyse the work and summarise it in your own words.
- It is vital to start the structure of the final report early rather than attempting to write it all at the end. If you include appropriate headings and subheadings, you can add notes and comments on what each section will require. This helps ensure you do not overlook anything and allows you to build the project report gradually.

3.1. Project Logbook

A detailed and accurate logbook record of all project-related activities, including notes, experiments, search results, and references, throughout the project's duration, is essential.

Use the logbook to keep a daily record of your progress, which will be crucial for the final dissertation report. It's also handy for jotting down notes on your meetings with your supervisor. Be sure to include the logbook as part of your submission for the Interim Progress and Final Progress Review meetings.

The Logbook can be a physical or **Electronic (see guidance on Moodle)** notebook to record your progress and key information accurately as you proceed through the project. Throughout the project, save reference documents, journal papers, data sheets, and background info in your logbook to track progress.

The core information to include is listed below and can be used directly to support the discussion in the marked review meetings with your supervisor.

This can include:

- A succinct summary of the tasks you have completed since the proposal was submitted. Please be specific (e.g., completed chapters 1 & 2, designed the artefact).
- Reflection & Iteration: Display your progress compared to your original Gantt chart. This visual helps you see if you are on track, ahead, or behind schedule. Reflect on issues you have encountered. More importantly, describe the steps you have taken, or intend to take, to resolve them. This exemplifies problem-solving capabilities.
- A short, single-paragraph summary of your project's status, major activities since the previous update, and primary early findings.
- Artefact Design: This section is important and should include any initial experiment, design, development or key elements of your artefact. It doesn't need to be perfect, but it should show concrete progress. Go beyond simply presenting results. Consider their

potential implications. How do they connect to your original problem idea/ questions? In what ways has your understanding of the project changed?

- Action Plan: Outline your main goals ahead of the upcoming deadline. For example, create a bullet-point outline for your final report, including chapter titles and main points for each chapter.

3.2. Project Timeline

Creating a timeline is crucial to the success of your project as it will:

- Enable you to consider all the necessary steps, from initial research to final submission, which is critical in understanding the project's scope and prevents you from overlooking essential tasks.
- Help you focus, since by setting deadlines for specific tasks, you generate a sense of urgency and a steady workflow, ensuring you make consistent progress rather than rushing everything at the last minute.
- Enable tracking your progress, as it will make it easy to see if you are on schedule, ahead, or falling behind. This early warning system lets you adjust your plan, reallocate time, or seek help from your supervisor before minor delays become major problems.
- Facilitate productive discussions with your supervisor about your progress and any potential obstacles.

Start by listing major project phases (e.g., Background Review, Methodology, Design, Analysis, Final Write-up). Then, break each phase into smaller, actionable tasks using tools like a Gantt Chart.

For example, Background Review (Complete by Oct 20)

- Identify key search terms: Sept 30th
- Find 20 relevant papers: October 4th
- Read and summarise papers: Oct 15th
- Write first draft of review: Oct 19th

The figure below depicts a sample Gantt chart with various project stages and key personnel events. The green horizontal bars depict completed activities, while the red ones are future activities. Software like Microsoft Excel, Trello, and Asana can be used to create Gantt charts.

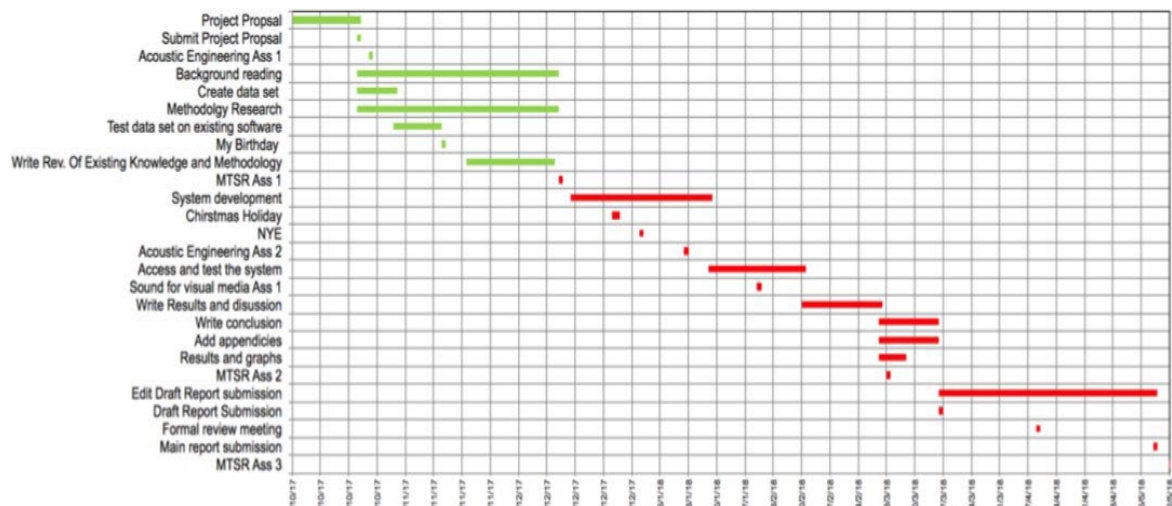


Figure 1: Gantt chart with various project stages.

4. Assessment Overview and Criteria

The project assessment plan divides the coursework across five assessment elements over two semesters. The detailed assessment brief, which outlines all assessment points, is available [here](#). Also, please consult the separate assessment guides for each element, as they provide more clarity on each component and detail the requirements for completing each assessment element.

Each summative assessment includes clear assessment criteria, which you can find in the assessment brief on Moodle. Alternatively, you can access the shortened version of the assessment brief by clicking on the assessment element name below.

All	Assessment Element	Weighting
	Project Idea Review	10%
	Interim Project Report	20%
	Final Progress Review	10%
	Final Report	40%
	Demonstration and Viva	20%

submissions will be automatically entered into the Turnitin system, which identifies similarities to other work and checks for the use of AI. Therefore, you should discuss your submission and ask guidance from your supervisor to ensure you follow academic standards, integrity and policies when submitting your work.

Note:

Visit the project Moodle page frequently, as updates or any changes to assessment deadlines will be communicated through Moodle.

4.1. Assessment Templates

We will provide generic report templates on Moodle along with explanations for each section, to ensure you cover all the required elements. These templates are for guidance only; it's best to discuss them with your supervisor to ensure you meet academic standards that are reflective and suitable for your discipline.

- Previous year's submissions will be uploaded to Moodle as samples for you to read and review. However, keep in mind that the assessment requirements were different, so use these samples to support your initial ideas rather than rely directly on them.
- When writing and delivering your work, consider your audience. Avoid jargon and colloquial language, and ensure your text is free from spelling, grammar, and punctuation mistakes whenever possible.

- Review all your reports, documents or posters before submission. One way is to read it aloud, as this will help you identify and catch errors in logic, flow of ideas, jargon, colloquial language, spelling, grammar, and punctuation. Over time, this will make you a better writer and improve your writing voice.
- Due to your increased knowledge of the subject area specialisms and an understanding of the unique project requirements that emerge through experiential learning, the project scope can and will shift as you develop your project, and this should be reflected in the reports.

4.2. Style and Conventions

The report should be written in your own words and should not contain extended extracts from the work of others. You may use direct quotes, but they must not account for more than 10% of your report. Identify direct quotes with inverted commas and reference them appropriately.

You should aim to produce a readable account that requires a logical structure to lead the reader from one discussion point to the next and through from one section/chapter to the next. The report language should be straightforward, jargon-free English, written in a conventional style using the third-person past tense, and readable by someone familiar with the general subject area, although not an expert in the specific topic.

The department's standard for degree project reports is like papers in technical/professional journals. You can find examples by referring to journals in your field of study. Use the following conventions and maintain a consistent style throughout the document.

- Fonts, Paragraphs and Line Spacing - Aim for a consistent approach throughout. Use Arial size 11 font, with a 35 mm left margin for binding. Set 1.5 line spacing and double-space between paragraphs. Do not indent at the start of a paragraph.
- Mathematical Symbols - Mathematical symbols and equations should be entered using a package (e.g., Equation Editor). Centre and number equations, with numbers in parentheses in the right margin. All variables should be discussed in the text.
- Figure Captions and Table Headings - A consistent style should be used as follows:
 1. When figures are referred to in the text, they should be written as: Figure 3.1 (with a space between Figure and the number), where 3 indicates the chapter and 1 the figure number. Write out the word "Figure" fully (not "Fig") in all cases; also, captions should be centred below the figure, in lowercase except for the first word and proper nouns.
 2. When referring to tables, write as: Table 4.1 (with a space). Table headings go below the table and should be formatted as follows: Table 4.1: Reconstruction scores (LSD, RMSE, CS) for three baseline models (VAE, WAE-MMD, AAE-ISO).
 3. Additionally, if you are incorporating a figure or table from another source, you must cite the source.
 4. Both tables and figures must have an associated discussion or be introduced in the main text. For example, as shown in Figure 3.1 and Table 4.1, the results highlight that X has a strong correlation to Y.
- Text Headings - Headings throughout the report should be consistent as follows:

1. Major headings and main sections should be in title case, with the first word and proper nouns capitalised. Allow a two-line space above these headings and a one-line space below.
 2. Section headings should be in lowercase, with the first letter of the first word capitalised and positioned at the left-hand margin. Allow a two-line space above these headings and a one-line space below. Subsection headings can be in italics, leaving a space above and below the heading.
- Pagination - Starting on the Introduction page, pages should be numbered using decimal numerals (e.g., 1, 2, 3, 4). Pages before the Introduction page should have lower-case Roman numerals (e.g., i, ii, iii, iv).

4.3. Ethics Review

Ethical approval is a critical step in any project. Before a project begins, it is crucial to get ethical approval, which gives confidence to the university that you have considered, reviewed and accounted for the following in your project:

- Physical or psychological harm, discomfort or stress
- Participant/client confidentiality
- Consent and data handling
- Conflicts of interest
- Vulnerable participants
- Bringing the University into dispute
- Issues in line with the government prevent strategy guidance

Therefore, you must complete the **Student Project Declaration**, which your supervisors must review and sign. **Failure to do this could invalidate your project.** The forms and details on how to complete the form, along with the deadline to submit the signed declaration form, will be posted on Moodle.

Note:

- This form should be completed before submitting your Interim Project Report.
- It is your responsibility to ensure the Student Project Declaration for ethics approval is completed (signed by you and your supervisor) before uploading it to Moodle.
- Your supervisor will then advise you if you need to complete the extended ethical forms below, which are available on Moodle:
 - CDT TEMPLATE Access Request Letter: Template for writing a cover letter to a company when requesting information to collect data (e.g., interviews, questionnaire)
 - CDT TEMPLATE Consent Form: Template for writing a consent form for informed consent by participants in your project
 - CDT TEMPLATE Information Sheet: Template for the information sheet that is provided to participants, so they understand what is involved in the project.

These forms will be necessary if your project involves working with external companies, collecting data, conducting interviews, or validating your solution with people. Your supervisor will advise if you need to complete these forms.

4.4. References, Bibliography, and Appendices

You should ensure all aspects of the project are underpinned by appropriate research cited in the body of the report. This enhances your work, reinforces the validity of your results and findings and demonstrates that you are familiar with accepted knowledge and thinking in the subject area.

Additionally, complete, correct and proper referencing of all sources used in undertaking the project is an essential requirement of a good report and necessary to avoid allegations of plagiarism.

You must use the appropriate referencing convention, as it helps the readers identify the sources of the information you have chosen to support your text. Your report should be presented in a formal academic style with citations and references in the Harvard Referencing Style/Format. Please use the link to learn more about the correct use of the Harvard format and discuss this with your supervisor or the Centre for Academic Success for further information.

Bibliography: refers to a list of relevant source texts you have used to support your project. However, you did not directly cite these resources in the report. You can include these in your report, and they should follow the Harvard Referencing style.

Appendices should have short titles and be separate documents appended at the end of the report. Only include appendices if they are necessary to explain details that are crucial for understanding the main report. You may also add detailed designs, code, or testing scripts as appendices.

4.5. Submission of work

All work is submitted electronically, and you must ensure that you securely retain final copies of all work submitted in an electronic form, should there be any problems with accessing your submitted work.

Throughout your project, back up your work regularly. Keep your backups safe. Unavailability or failure of computing equipment is not considered an exceptional circumstance and therefore cannot be part of any claim for extensions. Moodle shows the specific submission dates.

- All written submissions (Reports and Poster) should be uploaded to Moodle in PDF format. Submit your reports, including all appendices, as a single PDF file (< 40 MB). Submit any presentation slide deck in PowerPoint (PPT) or PDF format, suitable for projection.
- Digital artefacts, which may include developed software or video for the physical artefacts that have been created. Video evidence should be provided here. Submit all files as a single Zip file.
- You must complete and upload a **library waiver form** as a PDF (Scanned handwritten documents are acceptable) to allow the project to be made available in the University's digital library.
 - This identifies any copyright material that needs to be removed from the published version unless the copyright holder has granted explicit permission.
 - By uploading the form, you are effectively digitally signing it, and it does not need to be physically signed.
 - If non-disclosure agreements cover your project, please note this on the form so it should not be uploaded to the digital library.

Note:

The section "I confirm that the above project/thesis includes/does not include (please delete as appropriate) material copied from a source (e.g., a book) where ownership of the copyright does not belong to myself." This refers to copyrighted material in reports, such as technical manuals or proprietary company information. You must get permission or identify the material's location in the report on the waiver form for removal from library copies.

4.6. Assessment Marking

Assessment marking is carried out according to the published criteria for each element as shown in the assessment brief. The supervisor marks using academic judgement.

All reports will be double marked. Double marking will be based on the sampling principle, meaning that, randomly, 50% of the work will be double marked by one of the other supervisors, who will be randomly allocated. This is essential to ensure the marking is consistent, fair, and follows the assessment criteria while reflecting academic judgement.

The marks and feedback for each element will be released within 15 working days.

The final mark for the project is calculated as the weighted marks for each assessment element:

Final Mark =

$$((\text{Project Idea Review Mark} * 10\%) + (\text{Interim Project report Mark} * 20\%) + (\text{Final Progress Review mark} * 10\%) + (\text{Final Report Mark} * 40\%) + (\text{demonstration and Viva mark} * 20\%))$$

For Example: @ Element mark is out of 100%

Project Idea Review Mark = 50%

Interim Progress report = 65%

Final Progress Review mark = 45%

Final Report Mark = 70%

Poster and Viva Mark = 70%

$$\text{Final Mark} = ((\text{Interim Report Mark} * 20\%) + (\text{Interim Progress Review Mark} * 10\%) + (\text{Final Progress Review mark} * 10\%) + (\text{Final Report Mark} * 40\%) + (\text{Poster and Viva} * 20\%))$$

- $((50 * 10\%) + (65 * 20\%) + (45 * 10\%) + (70 * 40\%) + (70 * 20\%))$
- $(10 + 6.5 + 4.5 + 28 + 14)$
- **Final Mark = 64%**

Note

- Re-assessment opportunities will be offered in line with university regulations where a final mark is less than 39.5%.
- After completing all assessment marking at year's end, a moderation process occurs, which may suggest adjusting marks to ensure consistency in the assessment standard.
- External examiners will review a sample of project deliverables.

5. Innovation Fest Awards and Henderson Innovation Seed Fund

Your supervisor can nominate you after discussing it with you, or you can register to take part in the Innovation Fest, which will automatically enter you to win one of the five prizes. You or your supervisor will need to complete a separate form to confirm that you want to take part in the Innovation Fest. Details will be shared on Moodle. If you decide to take part, you will need to create a poster and present it during the Innovation Festival, where your supervisor and external industrial judges will assess your understanding of the problem, design choices, implementation

challenges, evaluation, and overall project management. The criteria by which the judges will assess your work are broadly based on the following:

- Professional, informative, concise summary of the project
- Motivated project with a solid foundation in research or industry need.
- Rigorous implementation and testing/evaluation.
- Understanding of the context of the project in the broader field (e.g., scope, limitations, future work).

Note:

The submission date for the poster and invitation festival poster presentation is fixed. There will be no extensions, as this work will not be marked or assigned marks.

Henderson Innovation Seed Fund

The supervisors are responsible for nominating students for the Henderson Innovation Seed Fund. The Henderson Innovation Funds have specific criteria, which will be shared closer to the time on Moodle and via email.

If you are interested in taking part in the innovation fest competition and/or qualifying for the Henderson Innovation Seed Fund, discuss this with your supervisor at the start of the project. This will help your supervisor guide and support you in understanding the requirements and preparing for these funds and awards.

